HEART FAILURE
Ejection fraction below 40 percent defines systolic failure.
ACE inhibitors are first-line therapy in all patients.

Beta blockers reduce mortality once the patient is euvolaemic.
Spironolactone is added in persistent class III symptoms.

AORTIC STENOSIS
An ejection systolic murmur radiates to the carotids.
Syncope on exertion is an ominous feature.

A valve area below 1.0 square centimetre indicates severe stenosis.